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Mustikkatyypin tuore kangasmetsä, Kujala, T. ja V.- Soveri, 1947, J, CC BY 4.0, via Wikimedia Commons

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Spring bloom in drought, BLMArizona, Public domain, via Wikimedia Commons

New growth in Isle Royale National Park, Sean Carey, public domain, National Park Service

Spring growth in forest, Public domain, via Wikimedia Commons

Forest Service Pacific Northwest Region, Public domain, via Wikimedia Commons

The Ecological Relations of The Roots, Weaver, John E. (John Ernst), 1884-1966, No restrictions, via Wikimedia Commons

Ficus indica, the Banyan tree, "Root," Encyclopædia Britannica (11th ed.), v. 23, 1911, p. 713, fig. 7.

Tree-roots, July 1890 - 1890, Vincent van Gogh, Public domain, via Wikimedia Commons

Ergaki, Pinus sibirica forest, roots, Taigish Valley, Sayan Mountains, Russia Vyacheslav Argenberg, CC BY 4.0, via Wikimedia Commons

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Issue #1

Winter 2026

WHAT MAKES US RISE?

Mosaic Atlanta Research Group

WHAT MAKES US RISE

Mosaic Atlanta
in cooperation with
People's Campaign
to Stop Cop City

2026 Mosaic Atlanta
mosaicatlanta.org

**"The time is now.
The bridges
towards liberation
start with us
let's build them."**

Mahmoud Khalil
Palestinian Student Activist and Organizer

**Who are the people in this time in your life
who deeply support you? Believe in you?
Give you their love?
Imagine their faces in this moment.
Their presence...
To just stop and reflect on everything that
makes us and supports us.
That makes us possible.
We celebrate interdependence.
We become the activity of creation itself.
Infinite conditions. Mutually co-arising. In a
great symphony of life. Of love. Of light.**

- Thich Nhat Hanh
Zen Master, Poet and Peace Activist

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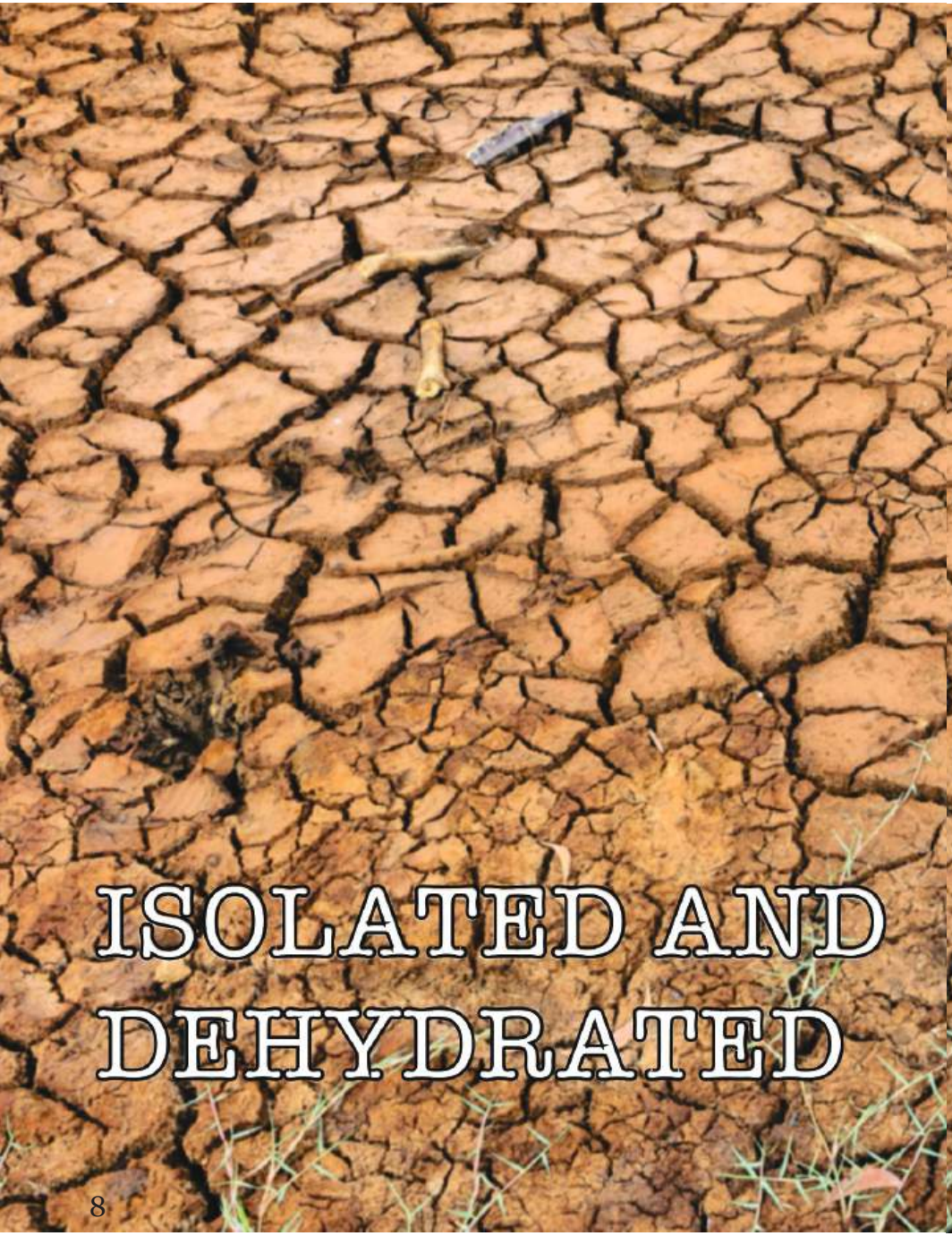
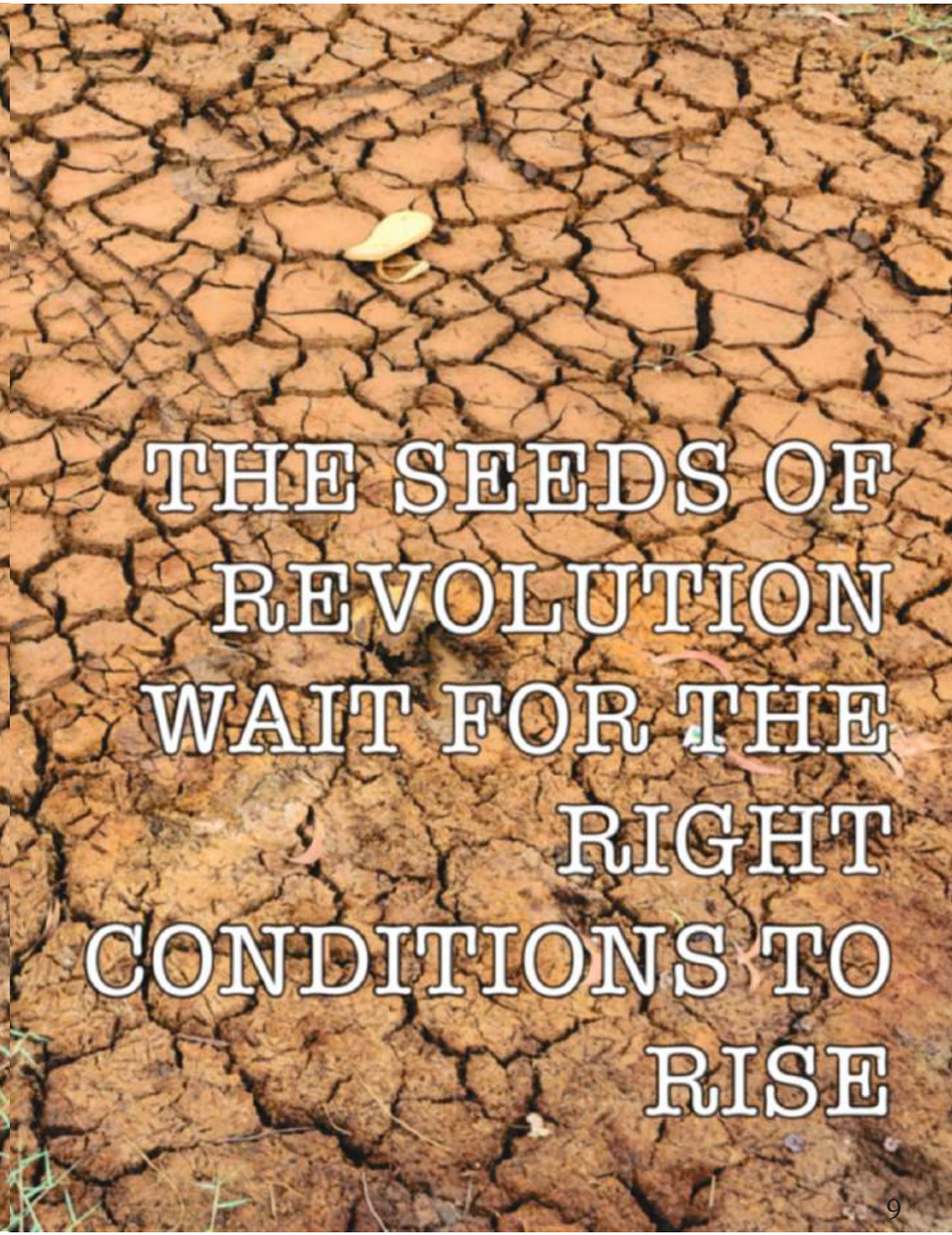
Introduction

It's time to build the world we want to live in.
Together we will protect each other.
Together we will rise.

Mosaic Atlanta's Research Group polled 192 Atlanta residents and found that the majority of people surveyed have lost faith in our current system. People are realizing that our democracy is not working for us and that we need real change. **As the United States tumbles down the path of fascism, it's up to us to look after each other in order to create the future we want.**

Mosaic Atlanta is a grass-roots activist collective. We believe in mutual aid, data sovereignty, and building power from the ground up. Mosaic Atlanta's Research Group is a working group of Mosaic Atlanta which is committed to finding solutions that will help organizations and activists develop the best strategies for achieving justice in our lifetime.


ISOLATED AND
DEHYDRATED


THE SEEDS OF
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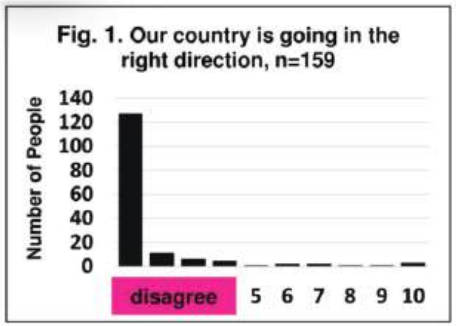
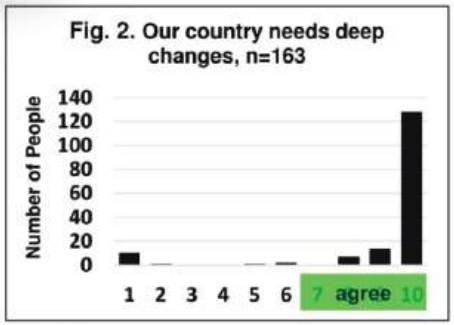
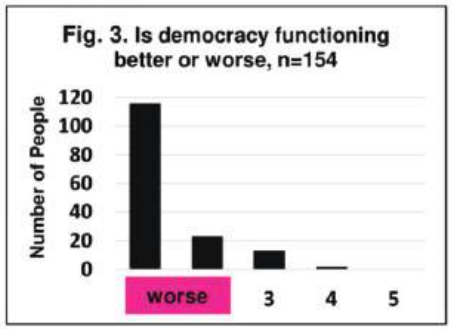
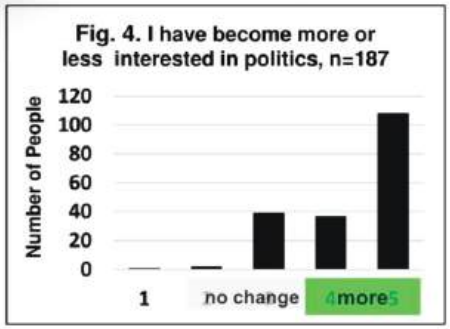
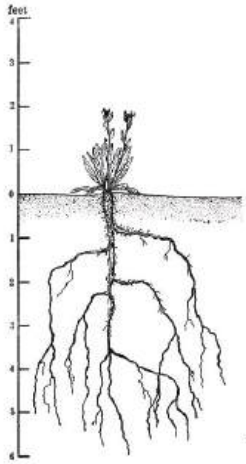
WAIT FOR THE
RIGHT
CONDITIONS TO
RISE

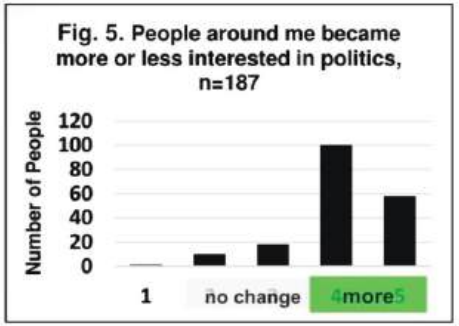








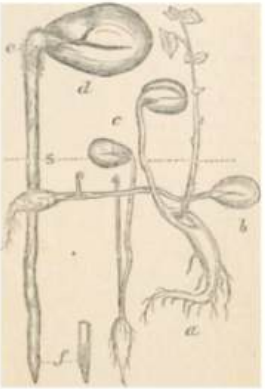




We have no option but to save ourselves

The People Want Change

Our survey found that people are very anxious about the future of the United States (Fig. 1). **People are looking for deep changes which neither the Republicans nor the Democrats are providing (Figs. 2 and 3).** We also found that despite the darkness of our times, people are very motivated to engage in politics (Figs. 4 and 5). **These survey results confirm that a significant majority of people are losing faith in our democracy and our politicians.**



Both the Republicans and the Democrats have proven, time and time again, that they are not here to serve us. We're done voting for "representatives" who do not represent us. Our elected officials represent the billionaires, who get richer and richer while we suffer from more wars and economic instability.

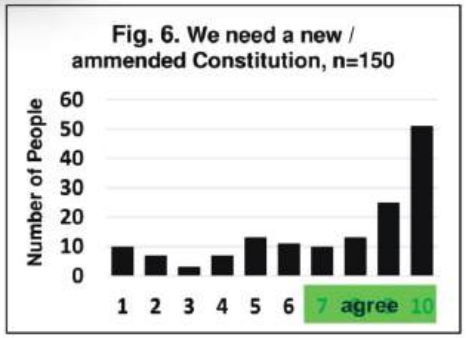
Enough is enough! It's time to work together to protect our communities from the violent fallout of failing United States' policies.

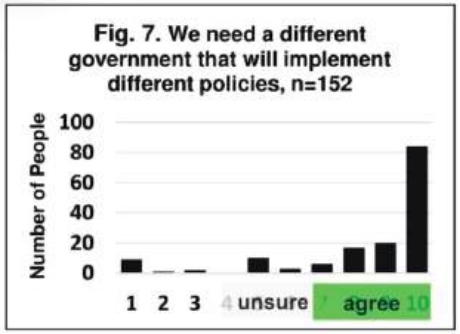
We have no option but to save ourselves. If you've been feeling this way, you're not alone. Our survey confirms that you're a part of a growing group of people who can see where this country is heading. Don't sink into despair. When we build and sustain connections with each other, our power grows and our fear fades away.

THE WINDS OF
CHANGE STIR
THE EARTH
SOMETHING
MIGHTY
BEGINS TO RISE
FROM BELOW

Reforms have failed to sustain us

Revolutionary energy is rising





We can choose our future.

Our most shocking results are that the American people are very interested in changing or replacing Constitution (Fig. 6). We saw that participants were also interested in taking things a step further by indicating that they strongly believe that a new government is needed now more than ever (Fig. 7).

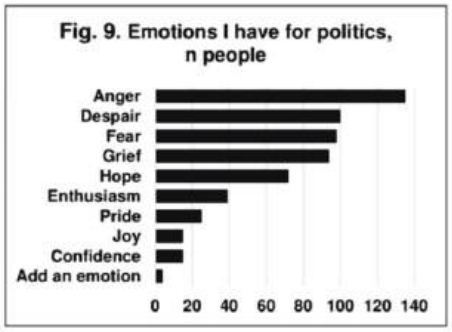
The Democrats and the Republicans have told us all our lives that we live in the world's strongest and most functional democracy. The events of our day-to-day lives, and the results of these surveys, show that more and more people are realizing that this is a lie: **We do not live in the American Dream, but instead the American Nightmare.** People are prepared and ready to accept the knowledge that we live in an oligarchy. Only radical change will solve the issues that face us today (Fig. 8).

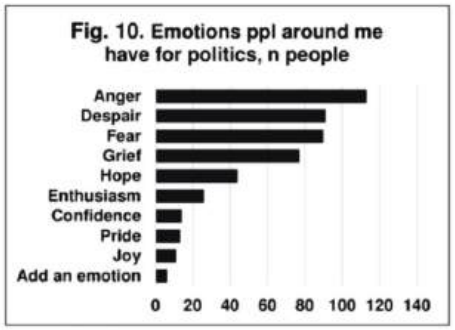
Working-class and oppressed people of the United States:
You are not alone!
We are in uncertain times, but we also have more potential than ever before.

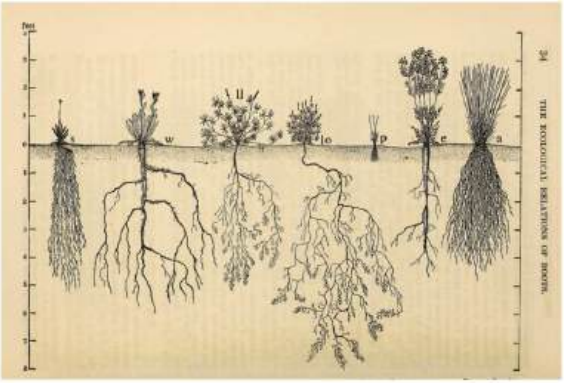
BENEATH
THE
CANOPY
OF
DYSTOPIA
A NETWORK OF
LOVE AND
RESISTANCE
BLOOMS IN
THE SHADOWS

The reality is that ICE is already here in Atlanta.

They are actively building a detention center in Social Circle, Georgia, in order to house over 8,000 of our neighbors[1]. ICE is preparing to launch attacks on our beloved community.We can be prepared if we start the work of building our care networks.







The antidote to despair is action: are you ready to protect yourself and your neighbors?

1. "New insight into ICE detention facility in Social Circle," Alani Letang, 2/24/2026
https://www.atlantanewsfirst.com/2026/02/24/new-insight-into-ice-detention-facility-social-circle/
"ICE's Warehouse Purchases Herald New Model for Immigration Detention," Aaron Reichlin-Melnick 2/24/2026
https://www.americanimmigrationcouncil.org/blog/ice-buys-warehouses-immigration-detention/

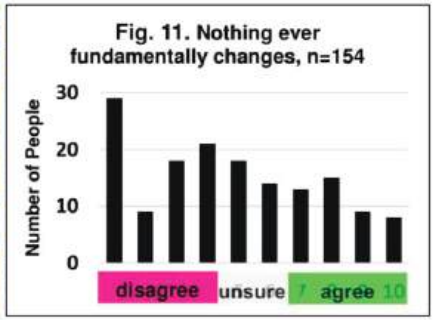
ANOTHER WORLD IS POSSIBLE!

Our isolation from each other, and our reliance on our political system to meet our needs, is what fuels our feelings of powerlessness.

While our present moment is dark, this is the perfect time to create a brighter future together. The more politicians choose corporate money over working people's best interests, the more we need to redirect our energy into our own local communities and workplaces.
The hardest part is getting started. The key is knowing that you don't have to do anything alone. Our survey proves that you are surrounded by people who care about the same issues as you do! Find those people in your neighborhood, and start building networks of mutual care and people power.

EASY NEIGHBORHOOD CARE NETWORK RECIPE

1.Form a neighborhood safety group chat on Signal, which is a free encrypted chat platform.
2. Pick a place and time to have the first community meeting
3. Make a flyer advertising the first meet up. Include a QR code for the Signal group
4. Meet up and get aquatinted! Leave space for introductions and time to explore on what folks have interest in building together. This can include:
- **4a.**Resources/Hobby/Skill Share
- **4c.**ICE Raid Watch Group
- **4a.**Tenants' Union
- **4b.**Community garden



WE'RE ROOTED HERE.
AND THEY CAN'T PULL US UP."
~Harriet Tubman

ADDITIONAL RESOURCES

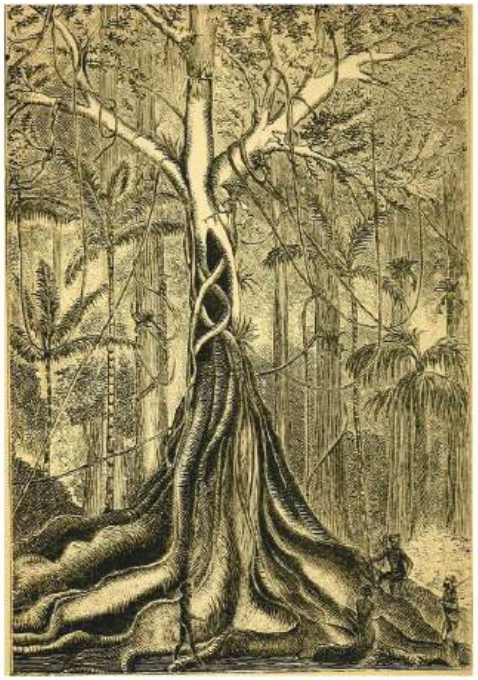
"Dispatch, Please Advise!"
Tactics for Fighting the Federal Occupation of Minnesota by ICE
Red-Winged Blackbird collective (Minnesota, USA), 2026
https://antidotezine.com/2026/01/27/dispatch-please-advise/

Emergent Strategy
Shaping Change Shaping Worlds
adrienne maree brown,
AK press, 2017
https://cdn.bookey.app/files/pdf/book/en/emergent-strategy.pdf

How to Build a Care Netwrok
Ayeola Omolara Kaplan,
Spark Reproductive Justice NOW!, 2025
https://sparkrj.org/how-to-build-a-care-network-zine/

I WILL NOT CRAWL
Excerpts from Robert F. Williams on Black struggle and armed self-defense in Monroe, NC
Robert F. Williams,
North Carolina Piece Corps, 2017
https://itsgoingdown.org/wp-content/uploads/2017/02/i_will_not_crawl_print.pdf

Project South
"Our work is rooted in the legacy of the Southern Freedom Movement and our mission of cultivating strong social movements in the South powerful enough to contend with some of the most pressing and complicated social, economic, and political problems we face today."
https://projectsouth.org



REVOLUTIONARY LETTER #4
By Diane di Prima

Left to themselves people
grow their hair.
Left to themselves they
take off their shoe's.
Left to themselves they make love
sleep easily
share blankets, dope & children
they are not lazy or afraid
they plant seeds, they smile, they
speak to one another. The word
coming into its own: touch of love;
on the brain, the ear.
//
We return with the sea, the tides
we return as often as leaves, as numerous
as grass, gentle, insistent, we remember
the way,
our babes toddle barefoot thru the cities of the universe